Cleveland Browns Offense: Scouting Report

Public data. Built from nflverse (nflfastR play-by-play, NGS participation, FTN charting), mapped onto the PFF GamePBP layout. Run concepts, PFF success codes, yards after contact and receiver alignment are not in this source; see *What nflverse cannot cover* at the end.

Sample: 17 games (Sep 07, 2025 to Jan 04, 2026) · 987 offensive plays · Opponents: BLT, BUF, CHI, CIN, DET, GB, LV, MIA, MIN, NE, NYJ, PIT, SF, TEN
Source: CLV_2025_nflverse_GamePBP.csv · Generated Nov 05, 2026 16:44 · Success = standard yardage definition · EPA = nflfastR model

62%	54%	-0.18	38%	33%
PASS RATE	NEUTRAL EARLY-DOWN PASS RATE	EPA / PLAY	SUCCESS RATE	3RD-DOWN CONVERSION

8%	7%
SACK RATE	EXPLOSIVE PLAY RATE

Key findings

TENDENCIES

- Passes on 62% of all plays and 54% of neutral early-down plays (1st/2nd down, outside 2-minute drills).
- QB alignment is a strong run/pass key: under center they run 72% of the time (n=319); in shotgun they pass 80% (n=645).
- Pistol is a real part of the menu: 23 plays, 48% pass.
- Base personnel is 11 (44% of snaps, 71% pass). 6 groupings reach 10+ plays.
- Tell: 3rd Down + Extra Long (11+) → pass 96% of the time (n=54, 95% lower bound 87%).
- Tell: 3rd Down + Medium (4-6) → pass 94% of the time (n=53, 95% lower bound 85%).
- Tell: 3rd Down + Long (7-10) → pass 93% of the time (n=70, 95% lower bound 84%).
- Tell: Shotgun + 3rd Down → pass 88% of the time (n=200, 95% lower bound 82%).
- Run game is built on Middle and Right Guard: 47% of carries.
- Predictability: knowing personnel, alignment, down and distance lifts a defense's run/pass guess from 62% to 76% (leave-one-out).

STRENGTHS

- Most efficient run gap: Right End, +0.02 EPA/carry, 4.5 YPC, 50% success (n=28).
- Primary target: J. Jeudy (#3) (WR), 20% target share, 48 catches for 580 yards, -0.31 EPA/target, 30 first downs.
- Most efficient receiver: C. Tillman (#19) (WR), +0.17 EPA/target on 39 targets, aDOT 11.9, 3.0 YAC/rec.
- Lead back Q. Judkins (#10): 59% of carries, 3.6 YPC, 42% success. Favorite gap: Middle.
- Most total value: C. Tillman (#19), 6.5 total EPA on 39 touches + targets (270 scrimmage yards).

VULNERABILITIES

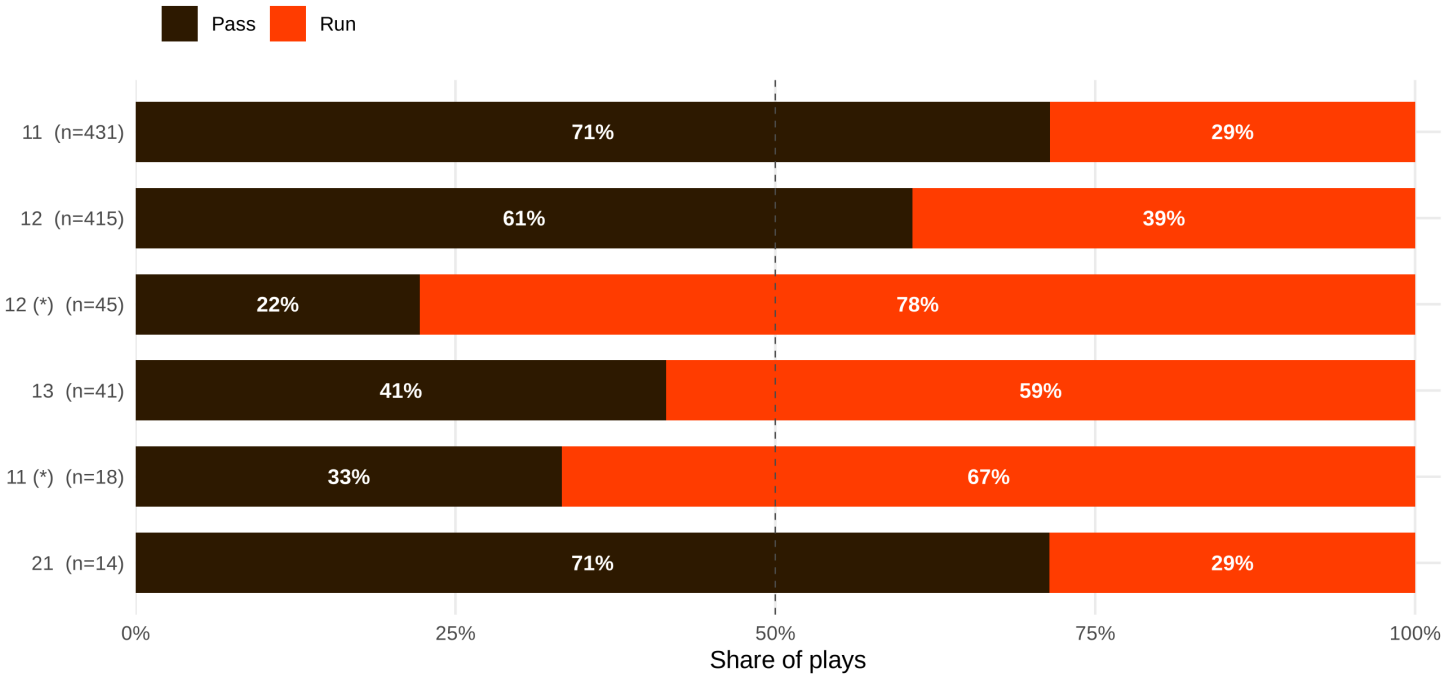
- Play action: 22% of dropbacks, -0.28 EPA/play vs -0.23 without (n=138 vs 476).
- Deep shots (20+ air yards): 11% of targets, 28% complete, -0.22 EPA/target (n=53).
- Pressure breaks the passing game: -0.64 EPA/dropback when pressured vs +0.00 clean. Pressured on 38% of dropbacks; sack rate 8%.
- Least efficient run gap: Left Guard, -0.24 EPA/carry, stuffed (0 or fewer yards) on 22% (n=37).
- On 3rd and Extra Long (11+) they convert only 9% (n=54); they pass 96% of the time there. Overall 3rd-down conversion: 33%.
- Least productive personnel: 21, -0.32 EPA/play (n=14, 71% pass).
- High-volume, low-return target: J. Jeudy (#3) (WR), 20% of targets but -0.31 EPA/target and 47% catch rate.

n = the number of plays (or carries / targets) behind a number, i.e. the sample size. Findings are generated by fixed rules (see Methodology) and include sample sizes. Treat any rate built on fewer than 10 plays as anecdotal.

1. Personnel run/pass tendencies

Run/pass split by personnel

Groupings with at least 10 plays. n = number of plays in that grouping



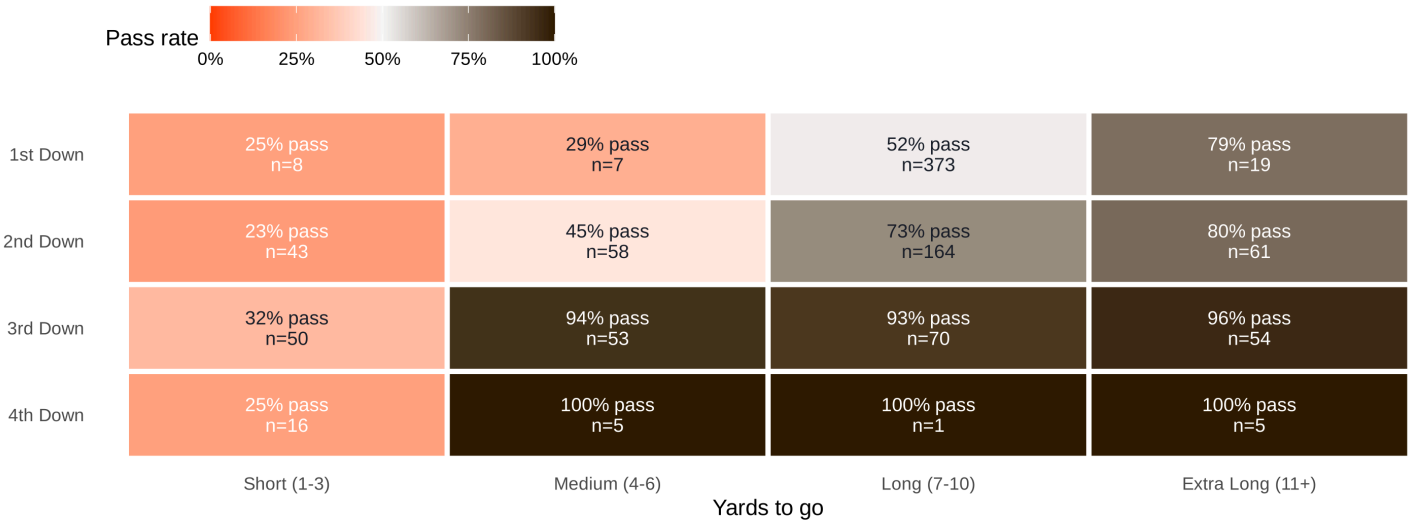
Data: nflverse (nflfastR pbp, NGS participation, FTN charting)

Personnel	Plays	Snap %	Pass %	Pass % 95% CI	Run EPA	Pass EPA	Success
11	431	44%	71%	67%-76%	-0.14	-0.22	36%
12	415	42%	61%	56%-65%	-0.07	-0.25	40%
12 (*)	45	5%	22%	13%-36%	-0.07	+0.22	40%
13	41	4%	41%	28%-57%	-0.17	-0.34	32%
11 (*)	18	2%	33%	16%-56%	+0.05	-0.75	33%
21	14	1%	71%	45%-88%	-0.07	-0.42	50%
02	7	1%	100%	65%-100%	n/a	-1.01	0%
13 (*)	7	1%	0%	0%-35%	+0.31	n/a	57%
10	5	1%	60%	23%-88%	+0.41	+0.94	60%
01	1	0%	0%	0%-79%	-0.17	n/a	100%
01 (*)	1	0%	100%	21%-100%	n/a	-1.80	0%
22	1	0%	0%	0%-79%	-0.36	n/a	0%
22 (*)	1	0%	0%	0%-79%	-1.77	n/a	0%

2. Down-and-distance tendencies

Pass rate by down and distance

Each box: share of plays that were passes, and n = number of plays in that down-and-distance situation



Data: nflverse (nflfastR pbp, NGS participation, FTN charting)

Down	To go	Plays	Pass %	Run EPA	Pass EPA	Success
1st Down	Short (1-3)	8	25%	+0.18	-0.33	38%
1st Down	Medium (4-6)	7	29%	-0.11	+0.51	71%
1st Down	Long (7-10)	373	52%	-0.14	-0.17	41%
1st Down	Extra Long (11+)	19	79%	+0.09	-0.15	37%
2nd Down	Short (1-3)	43	23%	+0.06	-0.82	65%
2nd Down	Medium (4-6)	58	45%	-0.23	-0.26	41%
2nd Down	Long (7-10)	164	73%	-0.20	+0.02	34%
2nd Down	Extra Long (11+)	61	80%	-0.51	-0.43	16%
3rd Down	Short (1-3)	50	32%	-0.06	+0.02	62%
3rd Down	Medium (4-6)	53	94%	+0.96	-0.23	40%
3rd Down	Long (7-10)	70	93%	-0.50	-0.41	27%
3rd Down	Extra Long (11+)	54	96%	-0.48	-0.19	9%
4th Down	Short (1-3)	16	25%	+1.19	-0.15	75%
4th Down	Medium (4-6)	5	100%	n/a	-3.57	0%
4th Down	Long (7-10)	1	100%	n/a	-0.29	0%
4th Down	Extra Long (11+)	5	100%	n/a	-2.37	0%

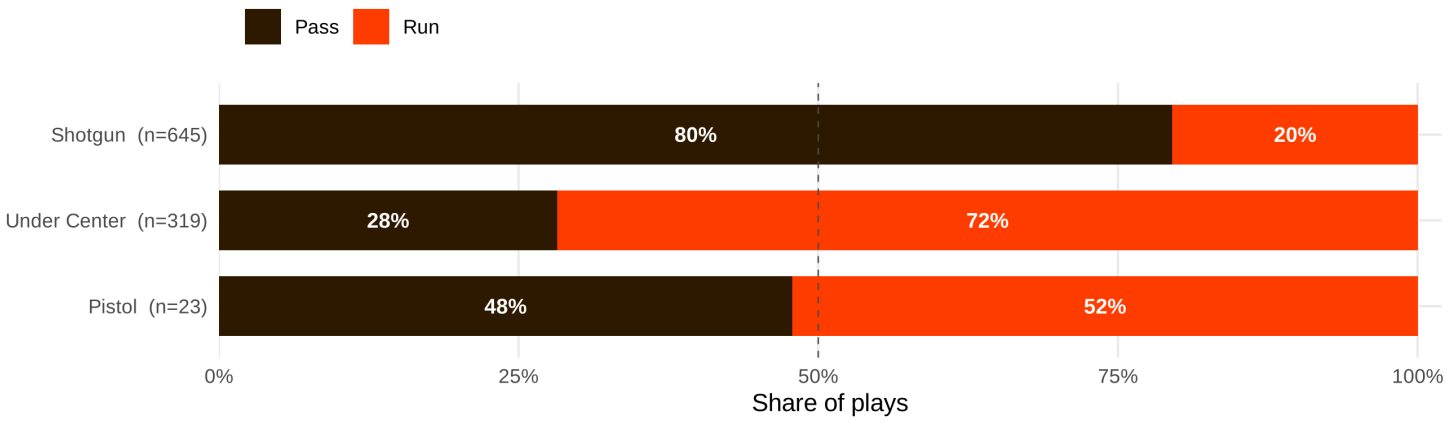
By field position (yards from the opponent's end zone):

Zone	Plays	Pass %	EPA/play	Success
Goal to Go (1-10)	54	41%	+0.14	43%
Red Zone (11-20)	63	62%	-0.23	30%
Plus Territory (21-50)	270	67%	-0.14	34%
Own Territory (51-80)	511	62%	-0.22	41%
Backed Up (81-99)	89	58%	-0.26	31%

3. QB alignment tendencies

Run/pass split by QB alignment

n = number of plays from that alignment; read small groups with caution



Data: nflverse (nflfastR pbp, NGS participation, FTN charting)

Alignment	Plays	Snap %	Pass %	Run EPA	Pass EPA	Run YPC	Pass Y/P
Under Center	319	32%	28%	-0.09	-0.27	3.6	4.4
Shotgun	645	65%	80%	-0.09	-0.23	3.4	5.0
Pistol	23	2%	48%	-0.14	-0.32	3.8	3.3

Alignment by personnel (groupings with enough plays):

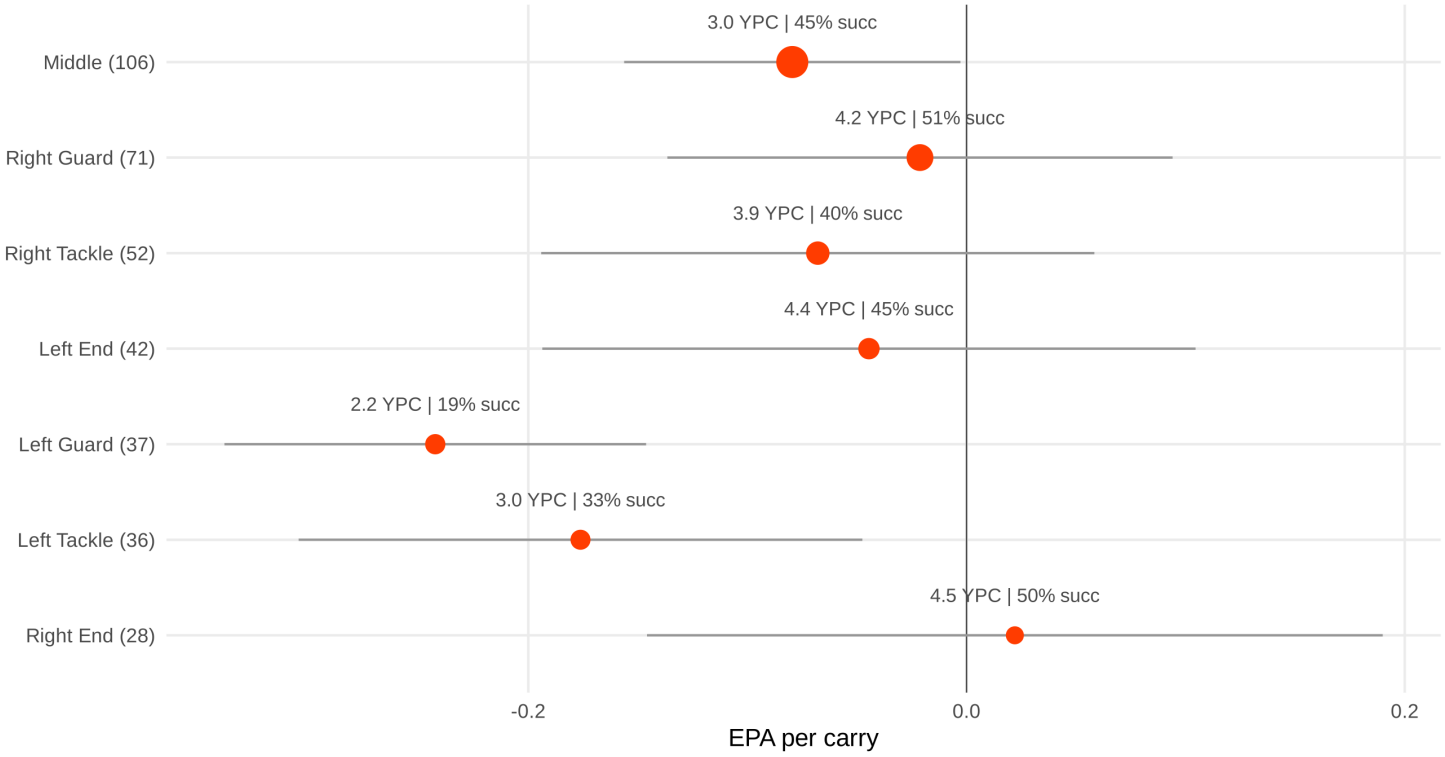
Personnel	Alignment	Plays	Pass %	EPA/play
02	Shotgun	7	100%	-1.01
10	Shotgun	5	60%	+0.72
11	Under Center	82	33%	-0.07
11	Shotgun	344	81%	-0.23
11	Pistol	5	40%	+0.05
11 (*)	Under Center	15	33%	-0.18
12	Under Center	149	28%	-0.18
12	Shotgun	251	81%	-0.16
12	Pistol	15	47%	-0.43
12 (*)	Under Center	42	24%	-0.05
13	Under Center	27	19%	-0.19
13	Shotgun	14	86%	-0.32
13 (*)	Shotgun	6	0%	+0.43
21	Shotgun	10	80%	-0.76

4. Run gap and direction: frequency and effectiveness

nflverse does not chart blocking schemes, so runs are grouped by the gap and side the play-by-play records (end / tackle / guard / middle). This answers *where* they run, not *which concept*.

Run gap and direction: volume and efficiency

Ordered by carries (in brackets). Point = EPA per carry, bar = +/- 1 standard error



Data: nflverse (nflfastR pbp, NGS participation, FTN charting)

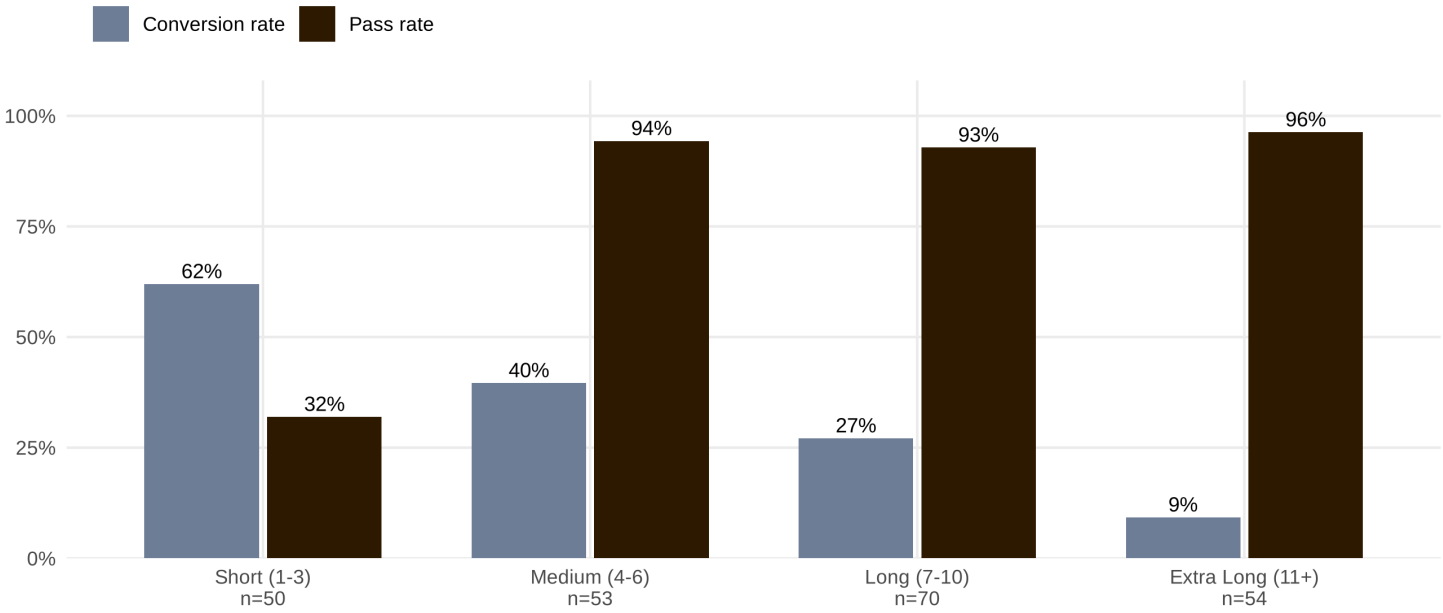
Concept	Carries	Share	YPC	Median	Success	EPA/carry	Stuff %	Explosive %	Under center %	Top personnel
Middle	106	28%	3.0	2.0	45%	-0.08	22%	6%	53%	12
Right Guard	71	19%	4.2	3.0	51%	-0.02	21%	8%	55%	12
Right Tackle	52	14%	3.9	3.0	40%	-0.07	17%	8%	75%	12
Left End	42	11%	4.4	3.0	45%	-0.04	26%	17%	76%	12
Left Guard	37	10%	2.2	2.0	19%	-0.24	22%	3%	35%	12
Left Tackle	36	10%	3.0	2.5	33%	-0.18	28%	6%	83%	11
Right End	28	8%	4.5	2.5	50%	+0.02	14%	14%	68%	12

1 carry with no charted run gap is left out of this table.

5. Third-down behavior and key targets

Third down: how often they throw and how often they convert

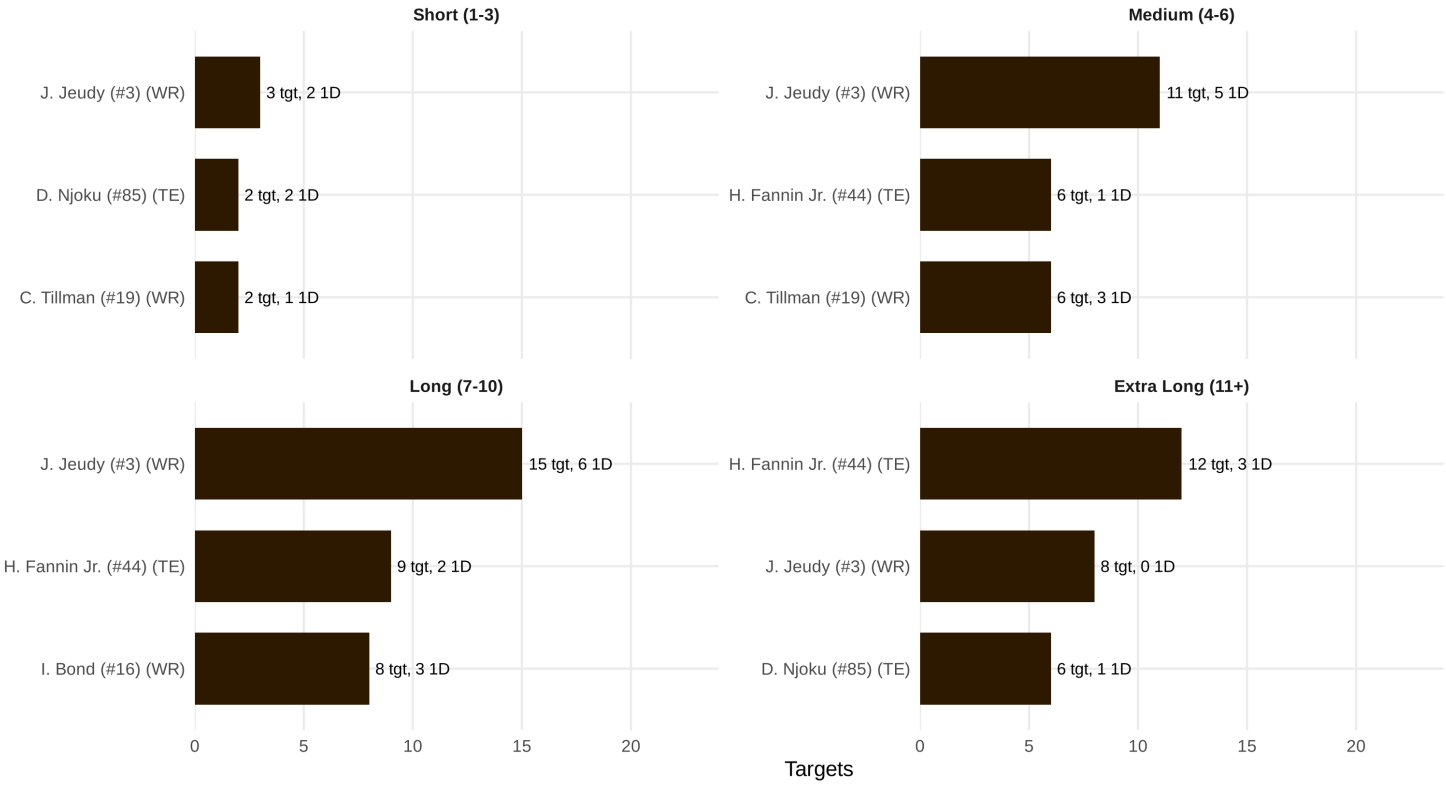
n = number of third-down plays at that distance



Data: nflverse (nflfastR pbp, NGS participation, FTN charting)

To go	Plays	Pass %	Conv %	Conv 95% CI	EPA/play	Gun/Pistol %	Avg air yds	Sack %
Short (1-3)	50	32%	62%	48%-74%	-0.03	56%	9.4	0%
Medium (4-6)	53	94%	40%	28%-53%	-0.16	98%	7.6	8%
Long (7-10)	70	93%	27%	18%-39%	-0.42	100%	9.5	15%
Extra Long (11+)	54	96%	9%	4%-20%	-0.20	96%	8.9	10%

Third-down target leaders by distance



1D = first downs gained on those targets. Data: nflverse (nflfastR pbp, NGS participation, FTN charting)

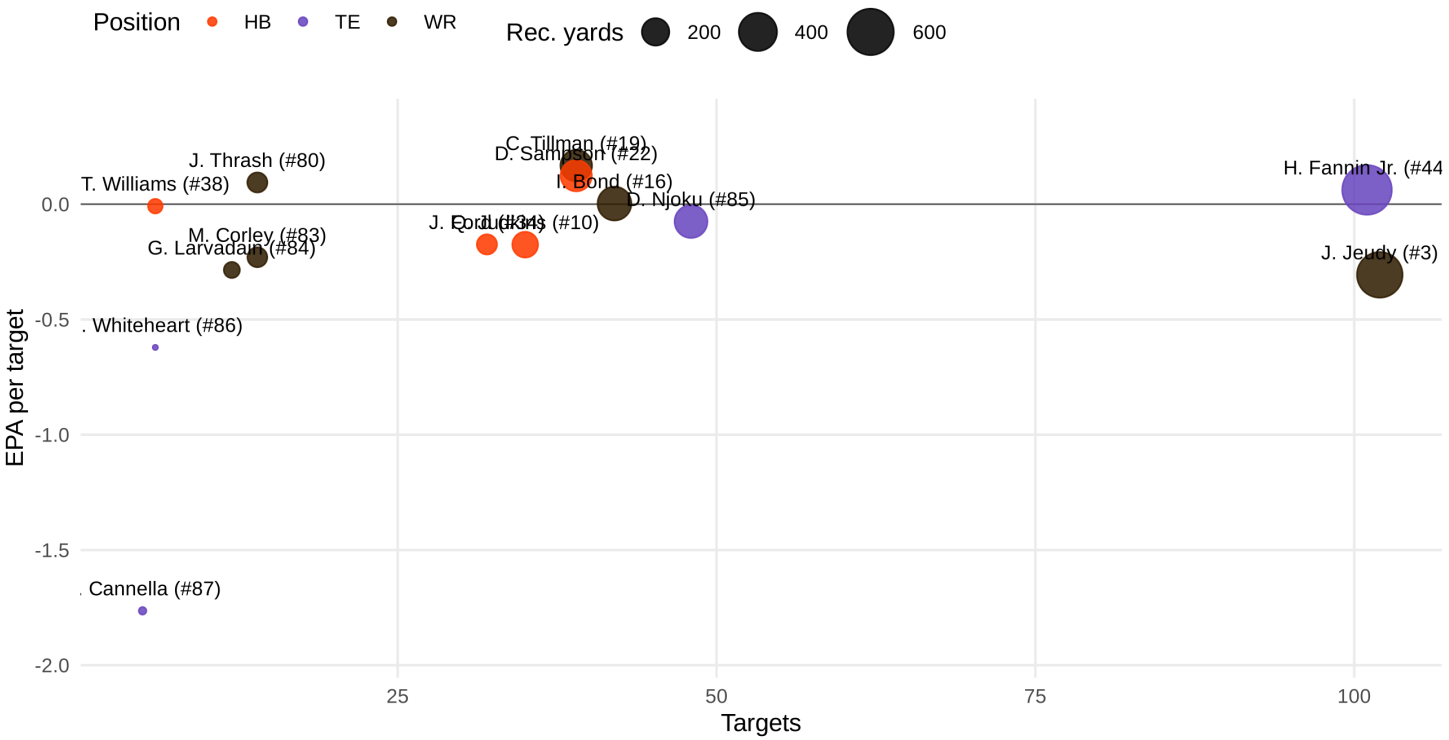
All third downs

Player	Pos	Targets	Share	Rec	Yds	1st downs	EPA/tgt	aDOT
J. Jeudy (#3)	WR	37	26%	17	186	13	-0.30	11.6
H. Fannin Jr. (#44)	TE	28	20%	16	171	7	-0.12	6.5
I. Bond (#16)	WR	19	13%	8	154	5	-0.17	19.1
C. Tillman (#19)	WR	14	10%	8	109	6	+0.15	12.1
D. Njoku (#85)	TE	14	10%	9	90	4	-0.77	6.0
J. Ford (#34)	HB	9	6%	7	53	3	+0.04	-2.2
D. Sampson (#22)	HB	5	3%	4	110	4	+1.86	-1.0
G. Larvadain (#84)	WR	5	3%	3	35	1	+0.18	10.6

6. Most effective players and how they produce

Receiving volume vs. efficiency

Players with at least 5 targets

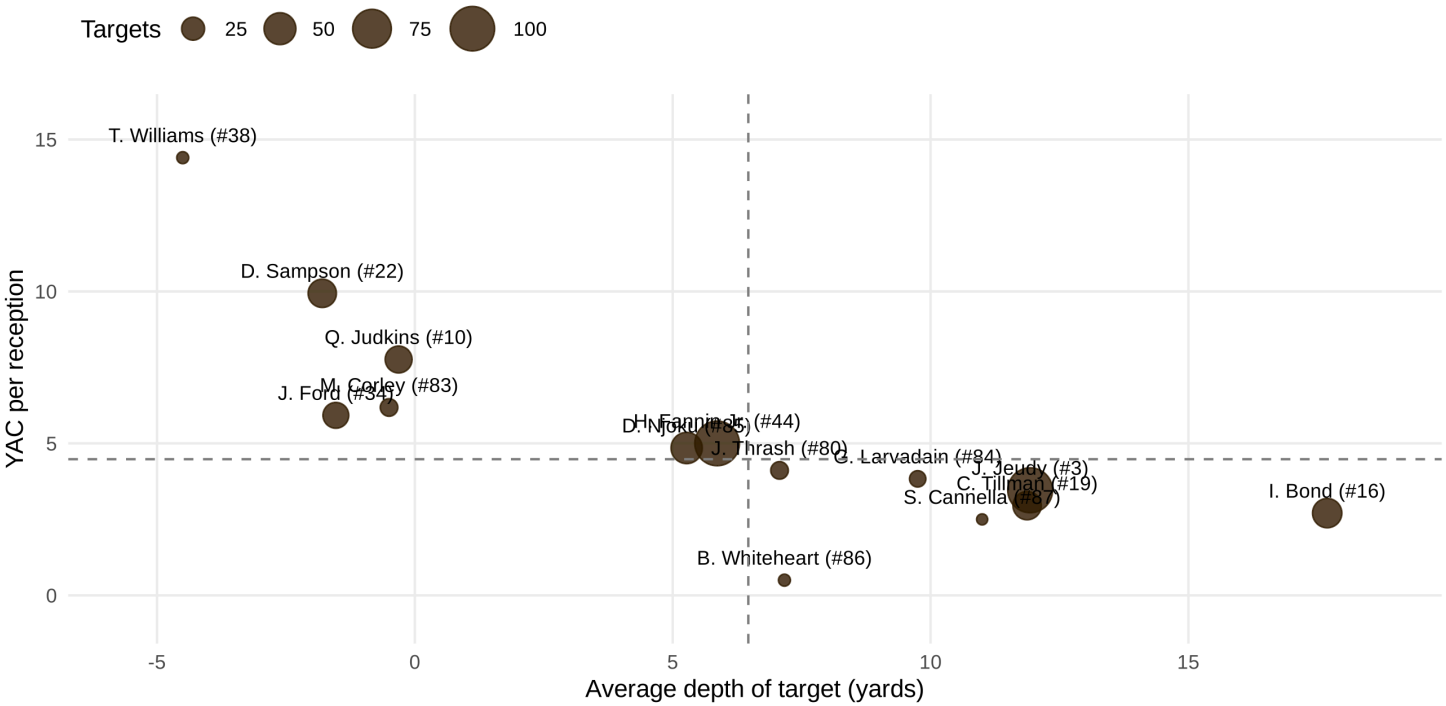


Data: nflverse (nflfastR pbp, NGS participation, FTN charting)

Player	Pos	Tgt	Share	Rec	Yds	Catch %	Y/Tgt	aDOT	YAC/Rec	EPA/Tgt	1D	Top route
J. Jeudy (#3)	WR	102	20%	48	580	47%	5.7	11.9	3.5	-0.31	30	IN/DIG
H. Fannin Jr. (#44)	TE	101	20%	68	690	67%	6.8	5.9	5.0	+0.06	30	HITCH/CURL
D. Njoku (#85)	TE	48	10%	33	293	69%	6.1	5.3	4.8	-0.08	11	HITCH/CURL
I. Bond (#16)	WR	42	8%	17	311	40%	7.4	17.7	2.7	+0.00	10	GO
C. Tillman (#19)	WR	39	8%	21	270	54%	6.9	11.9	3.0	+0.17	13	IN/DIG
D. Sampson (#22)	HB	39	8%	32	263	82%	6.7	-1.8	9.9	+0.12	7	SWING
Q. Judkins (#10)	HB	35	7%	25	175	71%	5.0	-0.3	7.8	-0.18	7	SCREEN
J. Ford (#34)	HB	32	6%	26	103	81%	3.2	-1.5	5.9	-0.17	4	SWING
J. Thrash (#80)	WR	14	3%	9	102	64%	7.3	7.1	4.1	+0.09	4	QUICK OUT
M. Corley (#83)	WR	14	3%	11	100	79%	7.1	-0.5	6.2	-0.23	5	SCREEN
G. Larvadain (#84)	WR	12	2%	6	63	50%	5.2	9.8	3.8	-0.29	3	IN/DIG
B. Whiteheart (#86)	TE	6	1%	2	4	33%	0.7	7.2	0.5	-0.62	0	HITCH/CURL

How receivers produce: depth of target vs. yards after catch

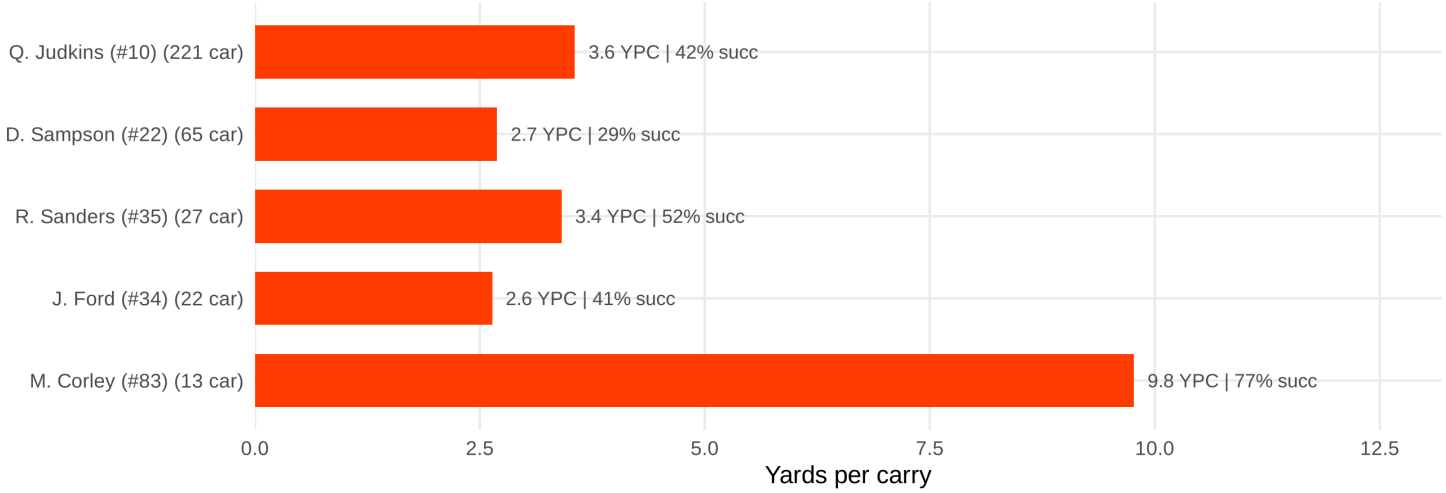
Right = targeted deeper downfield; up = more yards after the catch. Dashed = team medians



Data: nflverse (nflfastR pbp, NGS participation, FTN charting)

Rushers: yards per carry

Yards after contact is not in this data source, so carries are not split



Data: nflverse (nflfastR pbp, NGS participation, FTN charting)

Player	Carries	Share	Yds	YPC	Success	EPA/car	YBC	YACo	Explosive %	Stuff %	Top concept
Q. Judkins (#10)	221	59%	786	3.6	42%	-0.11	n/a	n/a	8%	21%	Middle
D. Sampson (#22)	65	17%	175	2.7	29%	-0.26	n/a	n/a	5%	28%	Right Tackle
R. Sanders (#35)	27	7%	92	3.4	52%	+0.03	n/a	n/a	4%	22%	Middle
J. Ford (#34)	22	6%	58	2.6	41%	-0.18	n/a	n/a	9%	18%	Middle
M. Corley (#83)	13	3%	127	9.8	77%	+0.56	n/a	n/a	46%	8%	Left End
H. Fannin Jr. (#44)	7	2%	13	1.9	29%	-0.25	n/a	n/a	0%	14%	Middle
T. Williams (#38)	6	2%	34	5.7	50%	+0.46	n/a	n/a	17%	0%	Middle
I. Bond (#16)	5	1%	29	5.8	80%	+0.18	n/a	n/a	0%	20%	Left End

Total offensive value (rushing + receiving EPA; QB passing EPA is credited to targets):

Player	Carries	Targets	Scrimmage yds	Rush EPA	Rec EPA	Total EPA	EPA/opp
C. Tillman (#19)	0	39	270	0.0	6.5	6.5	+0.17
H. Fannin Jr. (#44)	7	101	703	-1.8	6.2	4.5	+0.04
M. Corley (#83)	13	14	227	7.3	-3.2	4.1	+0.15
T. Williams (#38)	6	6	85	2.7	-0.1	2.7	+0.22
R. Sanders (#35)	27	4	113	0.9	1.2	2.1	+0.07
J. Thrash (#80)	0	14	102	0.0	1.3	1.3	+0.09
I. Bond (#16)	5	42	340	0.9	0.1	1.0	+0.02
S. Sanders (#12)	1	0	4	0.9	0.0	0.9	+0.92

7. Passing-game context

Split	Value	Dropbacks	Share	EPA/play	Success	Y/P
Play action	No	476	78%	-0.23	34%	4.8
Play action	Yes	138	22%	-0.28	38%	5.0
Screen	No	560	91%	-0.26	35%	4.8
Screen	Yes	54	9%	-0.05	37%	5.6
Pressure	Clean	381	62%	+0.00	42%	6.2
Pressure	Pressured	233	38%	-0.64	24%	2.7

Targets by depth

Depth	Targets	Share	Comp %	Y/Tgt	EPA/Tgt	INT %
Behind LOS	117	23%	77%	4.4	-0.20	1%
Short (1-9)	236	47%	67%	5.2	-0.14	3%
Intermediate (10-19)	97	19%	48%	8.3	+0.23	3%
Deep (20+)	53	11%	28%	9.6	-0.22	11%

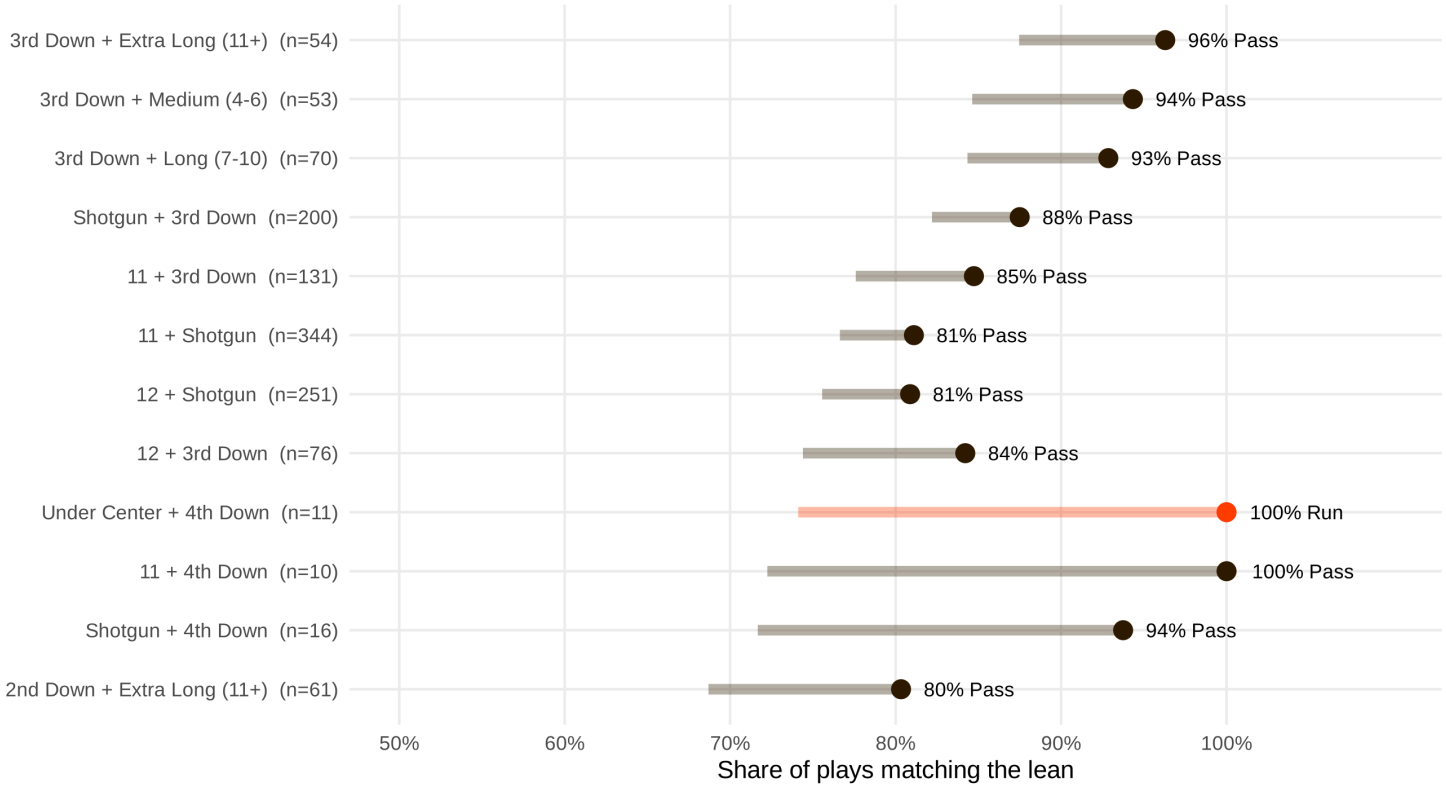
Results by defensive coverage faced (5+ dropbacks)

Coverage	Dropbacks	Share	EPA/play	Success
COVER 3	163	27%	-0.33	29%
COVER 1	160	26%	-0.25	36%
COVER 2	139	23%	-0.23	39%
COVER 4	58	9%	-0.13	36%
COVER 2 MAN	45	7%	+0.04	38%
COVER 6	25	4%	-0.91	36%
COVER 0	15	2%	+0.68	47%
COVER 9	8	1%	+0.09	38%

8. Pre-snap tells and predictability

Strongest pre-snap tells

Dot = observed rate; faded bar runs down to the 95% lower bound; n = plays with that cue



Data: nflverse (nflfastR pbp, NGS participation, FTN charting)

Always guessing the more common play type is right **62%** of the time. Using personnel, alignment, down and distance bucket (leave-one-out cell rates) is right **76%** of the time, a lift of **13%**.

Methodology and data notes

How the sample was built

Step	Plays
Offensive snaps in file	1118
Run or pass plays (drops penalties / no-plays)	1030
Downs 1-4 (drops PATs / 2-pt tries)	1030
Excluding garbage time	992
Excluding QB kneels and spikes	987

WHAT NFLVERSE CANNOT COVER (OR ONLY APPROXIMATES)

- Run concepts: nflverse has no blocking-scheme charting (inside zone, duo, power ...). Section 4 groups runs by gap and direction instead (e.g. 'Left Tackle', 'Middle').
- PFF success codes (pff_OFFSUCCESS): not in nflverse. Success uses the standard 40/60/100 yardage rule only.
- EPA / EP: nflfastR's public model, not PFF's. Values are close in spirit but not identical.
- Yards after contact: not in nflverse, so the before/after-contact split for rushers is unavailable (yards per carry is shown instead).
- Receiver alignment (slot / wide / backfield): not in nflverse. 'Main align' is blank.
- Personnel is counted from the roster positions of the 11 players on the field (RB+FB, TE). A WR listed as TE on the roster counts as a TE. '(*)' = 6+ offensive linemen.
- Garbage time is approximated with win probability (second half, pre-snap WP below 0.01% or above 99.99%). Calibrated against a licensed PFF sample.
- 2-minute flag: inside the final 2:00 of either half (PFF's 4-minute flag has no equivalent).
- Pressure is NGS 'was_pressure' (yes/no); time to pressure is not available.

Column names below refer to the PFF GamePBP layout the nflverse data was mapped onto.

- **Pass play / dropback:** `pff_RUNPASS = "P"`, which includes sacks and QB scrambles. **Run:** `"R"`. Penalties and no-plays (`"X"`) are removed.
- **QB alignment:** Pistol if `pff_PISTOL` is set, otherwise Shotgun if `pff_SHOTGUN` is set, otherwise Under Center.
- **Success (standard):** gaining at least 40% of the distance on 1st down, 60% on 2nd, and 100% on 3rd/4th, or earning a first down. PFF success codes are not in nflverse, so only the standard rule is used.
- **First down:** `pff_FIRSTDOWNGAINED = 1` or yards gained ≥ distance.
- **EPA:** `pff_EXPECTEDPOINTSADDED` as provided. Passing EPA is attributed to the targeted receiver.
- **Target:** a pass play with a recorded receiver, excluding sacks and scrambles. **Receiving yards:** yards gained on completions.
- **Explosive:** runs of 10+ yards, passes of 20+ yards.
- **Field zone:** `ABSOLUTEYARDLINE` is yards to the opponent's end zone (so 1–20 is the red zone).
- **Tell:** a pre-snap cue (personnel, alignment, down, distance, or combinations) with at least 10 plays where one play type reaches 80%. The 95% lower bound uses a Wilson interval.
- **Intervals:** rates show 95% Wilson intervals; run-concept EPA shows ±1 standard error. With samples this small, most differences between groups are not statistically distinguishable; the report shows n everywhere so readers can judge.
- **Garbage time** excluded: TRUE. **2-minute drills** excluded: FALSE. **Personnel "(*)"** marks a jumbo package (an extra offensive lineman replaces a skill player); merged into the base grouping: FALSE.

Data checks:

- Player names from CLV_2025_roster.csv (nflverse weekly rosters 2025)

Blank numeric cells (for example yards after catch on runs) are expected and listed for completeness.

Reproducibility: source file MD5 9a2ea3df40e7ac0f8cce012ed855b46d. Every table in this report is also saved as CSV and in one Excel workbook next to this file.